



RAGE OF THE RIVER

With the Kosi river changing its course, 25 lakh people are rendered homeless in the state. The crisis may aggravate in the coming weeks as the river continues to swell.

■ By Amitabh Srivastava

This is a region where, if you have survived the night, you are not likely to get your morning cup of tea because all milk-producing livestock is dead—swept away by the angry, swirling waters. No newspaper to know what's happening around because the approach roads and the railway tracks have been washed away; no electricity or any other signs of civilisation.

And you cannot even venture out for fear of getting drowned. Worse still, while water is all you see for miles around, there is not a drop to drink.

For 25 lakh marooned people in six districts of Bihar, that are close to Nepal, this is Apocalypse. They have suddenly found themselves on the river bed. And the stranded population looks blindly into the rising waters that are rapidly eating into more territories every day. Floods have never been alien to Bihar. In fact, the state is often struck by the